

Landscape Design

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Short Title: Landscape Design
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Horticulture
Author LMMURPHY
Credits 10

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module is a know-how and skills based module where students are introduced to the design process working from analysis, concept, through to design solution. It will enable students to design landscapes, carry out the necessary practices associated with landscape design, and the correct use of drawing equipment. Design theory and practice is taught through lectures, individual tuition, group tutorials, field trips and presentations.

Programmes

DESG-0066	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	2 / 3 / E
DESG-0066	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	3 / 5 / E
DESG-0066	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	2 / 3 / E
DESG-0066	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	3 / 5 / E

Indicative Content

- Prepare design plans and specifications for given situations
- Linear surveying, level surveying, transferring information to sketch form
- Principles of design and elements of design
- History of designed landscapes
- Use of drawing equipment and drawing standards
- Draft site survey and site analysis drawings
- Draft masterplan drawings including section/elevation drawings
- Draft planting plans
- Draft axonometric drawing
- Draft construction details
- Costing proposed new designed landscapes

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Practise linear and level surveying safely.
2. Distinguish the principles of design.
3. Design landscape projects.
4. Create designs to the detailed plan and specification stage.
5. Relate how the elements of design, history of design, and different styles influence the design process.
6. Interpret plans and specifications.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lecture

- Tutorial
- Studio
- Site Visit
- Seminar/Tutorial

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	2,5
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Portfolio</i>	50%	1,3,4,6

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Survey and analysis weak or absent and/or design portfolio missing more than 50 % of drawings. Poor knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.
- 40%-49%:** Identifies key site constraints and opportunities of site, portfolio of drawings complete, but design fails to fully exploit site or meet the needs of the client. Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter.
- 50%-59%:** Identifies key site constraints and opportunities as well as subtle details, portfolio of drawings complete, design meets needs of clients but fails to fully exploit site opportunities. Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject matter.
- 60%-69%:** Identifies key site constraints and opportunities as well as subtle details, portfolio of drawings complete, design meets needs of clients and exploits site opportunities. Demonstrates sound knowledge of the subject matter.
- 70%-100%:** Identifies key site constraints and opportunities as well as subtle details, portfolio of drawings complete, design meets needs of clients, fully exploits site opportunities and ameliorates site difficulties. Demonstrates a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Tutorial	72	
Independent Learning	174	

Essential Material

- Alexander, R. *The Essential Garden Design Workbook*. 1st ed.. England: Timber Press, 2009.
- Reid, G.W. *From Concept to Form in Landscape Design*. 2nd ed.. United States: Wiley, 2007.
- Robinson, N. *The Planting Design Handbook*. England: Ashgate Publishing, Limited, 2004.

Supplementary Material

- Mosser, M. and G. Teyssot. *The History of Garden Design*. London: Thames & Hudson, 2000.